

07 - Dragon Bestiary (Part I)

Project: Dragon Merchant Guild (*Working Title*)

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Introduction

While the Dragon Codex establishes the universal laws that govern dragonkind, the Dragon Bestiary serves a different purpose.

It is a living record of the individual species known to merchant guilds throughout the continent.

The entries contained within are compiled from decades—sometimes centuries—of observations by guildmasters, dragon keepers, explorers, veterinarians, researchers, and merchants who dedicated their lives to understanding these remarkable creatures.

No entry should ever be considered complete.

As guilds continue exploring new lands and working alongside dragons, new discoveries will undoubtedly reshape our understanding of these species.

How to Read This Bestiary

Every species follows the same structure.

Some sections describe biological facts.

Others describe merchant practices.

The "Species Story" provides historical and cultural context.

The "Guildmaster's Observation" contains practical wisdom passed between experienced guildmasters.

Finally, the "Evolution of Implementation" reminds future developers how the dragon's gameplay systems may evolve alongside the C# curriculum.

Species 001 — Stonejaw Drake

Scientific Name

Terradraco ferrumandibula

Ecological Class

Burrower

Guild Profession(s)

- Mining
 - Construction
 - Tunnel Surveying
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Habitat

Mountain foothills, cave systems, abandoned mines, and rocky highlands.

Stonejaw Drakes prefer regions where vibrations travel easily through solid rock.

Diet

Primarily mineral-rich stone, cave fungi, crystal moss, and occasionally small cave creatures.

Despite their frightening jaws, they rarely hunt large animals.

Temperament

Patient.

Focused.

Quiet.

Persistent.

Stonejaws rarely become aggressive unless their nesting tunnels are threatened.

Primary Instinct

Stonejaw Drakes instinctively seek underground vibrations.

When they detect hollow spaces beneath them, they begin digging until they uncover the source.

This behavior evolved as a method of locating underground water, mineral deposits, and safe nesting caverns.

Humans eventually realized that these same instincts naturally revealed valuable ore veins.

Guild Discovery

Early miners noticed that abandoned Stonejaw tunnels often intersected rich mineral deposits.

Rather than competing with the dragons, guilds began allowing Stonejaws to excavate naturally before expanding the tunnels themselves.

Modern mining guilds still rely on this ancient partnership.

Guild Applications

- Excavating mines
 - Locating ore veins
 - Tunnel maintenance
 - Underground construction
 - Clearing cave-ins
-

Strengths

- Tremendous endurance.
 - Exceptional digging ability.
 - Excellent underground navigation.
 - Can detect unstable rock through vibration.
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Weaknesses

- Poor eyesight above ground.
 - Slow movement in open terrain.
 - Dislikes loud metallic noises.
 - Becomes stressed when prevented from digging for extended periods.
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Care Difficulty

Moderate.

Stonejaws require reinforced sleeping dens with compact soil or stone floors.

Without opportunities to dig, they become restless and destructive.

Daily Routine

Morning is usually spent expanding or maintaining tunnels.

Afternoons are dedicated to transporting excavated rock.

Evenings are often spent quietly arranging stones around their nesting area before resting.

Interesting Behaviors

Stonejaws collect unusually smooth stones and carefully arrange them outside their sleeping dens.

Researchers still debate whether these collections mark territory, attract mates, or simply satisfy a natural instinct.

No two arrangements are ever identical.

Relationship with Humans

Stonejaws bond slowly.

However, once trust is earned, they remain loyal for decades.

Experienced handlers often communicate using gentle tapping patterns rather than spoken commands.

Relationship with Other Dragons

They coexist peacefully with most Burrowers but generally avoid energetic aerial species.

Young Stonejaws frequently imitate older dragons while learning excavation techniques.

Merchant Value

Extremely High.

A single experienced Stonejaw can uncover mineral deposits worth many times its yearly maintenance cost.

Species Story

Among mining guilds, it is said that the first Stonejaw Drake was never captured.

Instead, an exhausted miner became trapped beneath a collapsed tunnel with no hope of escape. Days later, the rhythmic sound of digging echoed through the darkness. A Stonejaw, following faint underground vibrations, unknowingly broke through the rubble and opened a path back to the surface.

The dragon accepted neither praise nor reward. It simply continued digging deeper into the mountain, searching for another hollow chamber. Ever since, miners have believed that Stonejaws are not searching for treasure—they are searching for the heartbeat of the earth itself.

Yet despite centuries of partnership, no guild has discovered what ultimately determines where a Stonejaw chooses to dig next.

Guildmaster's Observation

"Never rush a Stonejaw. They'll reach the ore eventually. Try forcing the pace, and you'll spend twice as long repairing collapsed tunnels."

Evolution of Implementation

C# Fundamentals

- Hunger
- Stamina
- Current Tunnel

OOP

- Burrower base class

Collections

- Multiple tunnel assignments

LINQ

- Find the nearest available Stonejaw

Async

- Long-running mining expeditions
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Future Expansion

- Tunnel networks
 - Cave ecosystems
 - Rare mineral preferences
 - Family groups
 - Underground territory mapping
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Species 002 — Hearthscale Drake

Scientific Name

Pyrodraco domesticus

Ecological Class

Highland Dragon

Guild Profession(s)

- Smithing
 - Hospitality
 - Cooking
 - Construction
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Habitat

Volcanic slopes, geothermal valleys, and rocky mountain settlements.

Diet

Charcoal roots, volcanic herbs, mineral ash, cooked meat, and heated stones rich in trace minerals.

Temperament

Gentle.

Patient.

Sociable.

Surprisingly affectionate.

Primary Instinct

Hearthscales naturally regulate the temperature of their nests by slowly releasing body heat through specialized vent scales along their backs.

This instinct evolved to protect eggs from harsh mountain climates.

Merchant guilds later discovered that the same instinct could warm homes, kitchens, bakeries, bathhouses, and blacksmith forges.

Guild Discovery

Mountain villages began building communal hearths around naturally nesting Hearthscales.

Long before furnaces became widespread, entire settlements depended upon these dragons during winter.

Guild Applications

- Bakery heating
- Forge support

- Public bathhouses
 - Kitchens
 - Winter shelters
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Strengths

- Reliable heat generation
 - Calm disposition
 - Excellent with children
 - Low aggression
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Weaknesses

- Performs poorly in tropical climates
 - Requires frequent hydration
 - Can become lethargic in extreme heat
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Care Difficulty

Low.

Provided they remain hydrated and socially engaged, Hearthscales are among the easiest dragons to care for.

Daily Routine

Most Hearthscales spend daylight hours helping kitchens and workshops before resting near communal gathering spaces during the evening.

Interesting Behaviors

They instinctively curl around cold stone walls while sleeping.

By morning, the surrounding room is noticeably warmer.

Relationship with Humans

Hearthscales actively enjoy companionship.

Many willingly seek out familiar workers after completing their daily tasks.

Relationship with Other Dragons

They are known to share resting spaces with smaller dragon species during cold weather.

Merchant Value

Very High.

One Hearthscale can replace several traditional furnaces while dramatically reducing fuel costs.

Species Story

In many villages, children grow up believing every warm home has a Hearthscale somewhere beneath its roof.

Whether or not that is true, history records that countless mountain communities survived brutal winters only because these gentle dragons refused to abandon their nests, warming entire families with nothing more than instinct and patience.

To this day, retired Hearthscales are rarely sold. They are usually honored as lifelong members of the communities they once protected.

Guildmaster's Observation

"Treat them like equipment and they'll do their work. Treat them like family and they'll never want to leave."

Evolution of Implementation

- Temperature system
 - Building warmth bonuses
 - Worker morale
 - Passive building effects
 - Seasonal mechanics
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Future Expansion

- Festivals
 - Winter events
 - Family bonding
 - Village reputation
 - Community interactions
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Species 003 — Riverveil Drake

Scientific Name

Aquadraco flumine

Ecological Class

River Dragon

Guild Profession(s)

- Water Management
 - Fishing
 - River Transport
 - Exploration
-

Habitat

Freshwater rivers, lakes, floodplains, and wetlands.

Diet

Fish, river plants, freshwater shellfish, and aquatic mosses.

Temperament

Alert.

Curious.

Gentle.

Independent.

Primary Instinct

Riverveils constantly seek clean, slow-moving water.

They instinctively remove floating debris from drinking areas before settling down, maintaining healthy waterways without understanding why.

Guilds later realized this natural behavior greatly improved water quality around settlements.

Guild Discovery

Early fishing villages noticed that streams inhabited by Riverveils consistently produced healthier fish populations and cleaner drinking water.

Rather than relocating the dragons, settlements grew around them.

Guild Applications

- Water purification
 - River surveys
 - Small cargo transport
 - Fishery support
 - Flood monitoring
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Strengths

- Superb swimmers
 - Excellent memory of waterways
 - Calm under pressure
 - Highly adaptable
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Weaknesses

- Uncomfortable far from water
 - Poor climbers
 - Easily dehydrated in dry climates
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Care Difficulty

Moderate.

Riverveils require constant access to clean water and regular opportunities to swim.

Daily Routine

River patrols begin shortly after sunrise.

Afternoons are spent assisting fishing crews or transporting cargo.

Evenings are devoted to quiet swimming before resting along sheltered riverbanks.

Interesting Behaviors

Before drinking, Riverveils carefully push floating leaves, branches, and debris toward the riverbank.

Even hatchlings perform this behavior instinctively.

Relationship with Humans

Riverveils respect patient handlers but dislike unnecessary noise.

Many eventually learn the daily routines of entire riverside communities.

Relationship with Other Dragons

They cooperate particularly well with Marsh Dragons and generally avoid Highland species.

Merchant Value

High.

Healthy waterways increase agriculture, transportation, fishing, and settlement growth simultaneously.

Species Story

Old sailors often joke that rivers remember every Riverveil that has ever lived.

No one knows why generations of Riverveils follow nearly identical migration routes despite never meeting their ancestors. Some scholars believe the rivers themselves shape their instincts. Others argue the dragons possess memories carried through bloodlines.

Whatever the truth may be, experienced captains trust a Riverveil's chosen path more than any map ever drawn.

Guildmaster's Observation

"If your Riverveil refuses to cross a stretch of water, don't argue with it. Ask what it noticed that you didn't."

Evolution of Implementation

- Water quality values
 - Fishing bonuses
 - River pathfinding
 - Seasonal flooding
 - Async exploration missions
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Future Expansion

- Weather systems
 - Flood events
 - Fish ecosystems
 - River trade routes
 - Water chemistry
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End of Part I

The species recorded in this volume represent only the beginning of the guild's understanding of dragonkind.

Many more await discovery, and even those described here continue to surprise the scholars and guildmasters who work alongside them.

As every seasoned dragon keeper eventually learns:

The day you believe you fully understand a dragon is the day it teaches you something new.